

# Respiratory Sound Listening Task

## Instructions

Thank you for helping with this. It should take about **75 minutes**, and you can stop and resume at any time — nothing needs to be finished in one sitting.

### Setup (2 minutes)

1. Use **headphones or earbuds**, not laptop speakers — the sounds we are asking about are quiet and very brief, and laptop speakers cannot reproduce them clearly.
2. Sit somewhere quiet. Set a comfortable volume using `reference_sounds/example_normal.wav`, then **do not change the volume** afterward — every clip is recorded at the same loudness.

### Step 1: Calibrate (5 minutes)

Listen to every file in the `reference_sounds/` folder before labeling anything. These examples show what we mean by each term below, so we are both using the same words for the same sounds. Return to them at any time during the task if you are unsure.

*Note: these reference examples are drawn from the dataset's own existing labels, not selected by a clinician. If one sounds mislabeled to you, please tell us — that is useful information on its own.*

### Step 2: Label the clips (about 70 minutes)

Open `labels.xlsx`. Every answer cell is a dropdown menu, so you select an option rather than type it.

1. Play `clips/clip_001.wav` in any media player (double-clicking usually works).
2. Fill in the corresponding row using the dropdown menus. Replay as many times as you like before answering.
3. Move to the next clip. **Please go in order and do not skip ahead.** If a clip is too unclear to judge, choose `unsure` and move on — do not guess.

### The columns

| Column        | Options                                 | Notes                                                                    |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| crackles      | none / fine / coarse / both / unsure    | The one we care about most                                               |
| wheeze        | none / wheeze / rhonchi / both / unsure |                                                                          |
| confidence    | low / medium / high                     | Please be honest — low-confidence answers are still useful               |
| audio_quality | ok / noisy / unusable                   | Lets us exclude a bad recording rather than blame a good detector for it |
| notes         | free text (optional)                    | Anything else worth telling us                                           |

**Please use unsure freely.** An honest “unsure” is far more useful to us than a guess. If you mark many clips unsure, that is a genuine and useful finding for us — it will not mean your time was wasted.

### What we are *not* asking

You are not diagnosing a patient. There is no clinical history, no imaging, and nothing here affects anyone’s care. These are anonymous archived research recordings. The only question at any point is simply: *what sound do you hear in this clip?*

### When you are finished

If you were sent a **Google Sheets** link, your answers are already saved — just let us know you are done. Otherwise, please email the completed `labels.xlsx` file back to us.

Thank you again for your time and expertise — this is genuinely helpful to the project.